



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

February

Inside this issue:

<i>Calendar</i>	2
<i>Worship Schedule</i>	3
<i>Youth Ministries</i>	4
<i>Children's Ministries</i>	5
<i>Council Report</i>	6
<i>Healing Hearts Bible Study</i>	7
<i>Seussical UMW</i>	8
<i>Meditation, Auction</i>	9
<i>Worship, Fellowship</i>	10
<i>Pastor's Message</i>	11

Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist Church,
published each month.

The deadline for March is

February 17

Contributions may be brought to the
office or emailed to:
office@minnehaha.org
3701 East 50th Street
Minneapolis, MN 55417

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

February

SUNDAY WORSHIP

9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.

10:00 am Education and Fellowship

11:00 am Worship with band and vocals.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.

Minnehaha Happenings in February

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
			1 10a Staff Meeting 1p Minn. circle 5p Methodicals 5:30p Wed. Supper 6:15p Children's Programming 6:45p Chancel Choir 7p Children's Council	2 <i>Groundhog Day</i> 9a Food Shelf Board 9a Fun & Fit 9a Minnehaha Playdate 10a Book Study 2:30p BM Music 6:30p Play Reh.	3 9:30a BM Music 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	4 8:45a BM Music 1p IAM Meditation
5 <i>Super Bowl</i> Communion 9a Worship 10a Ed/Fell 11a Worship 5p Play Reh. 7p SAA 7p Vent. Crew	6 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2p BM Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Finance 6:30p Pack Meeting 6:30p Play Reh. 6:30p Book Study	7 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p BM Music 6:30p Play Reh. 6:30p Toastmasters	8 9:30a Nok.Circle 5p Methodicals 5:30p Wed. Supper 6:15p Children's Programming 6:30p Memorials 6:45p Chancel Choir	9 9a Fun & Fit 9a Minnehaha Playdate 10a Book Study 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 2:30p BM Music 6:30p Play Reh.	10 9:30a BM Music 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA 7p Fellowship Hall reserved 7p Taizé	11 8:45a BM Music
12 9a Worship 10a Ed/Fell 11a Worship 12p Sus. Circle 2p MUMCMovies 4p Youth Council 5p Play Reh. 6p Youth Night (grades 6-12) 6:30p Togo Ch. 7p Pack 1 Plan. 7p SAA	13 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2p BM Music 6:30p Cub & Boy Scouts 6:30p Play Reh. 6:30p Book Study	14 <i>Valentine's Day</i> 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p BM Music 6:30p Play Reh.	15 5p Methodicals 5:30p Wed. Supper 6:15p Children's Programming 6:45p Chancel Choir	16 9a Fun & Fit 9a Minnehaha Playdate 10a Book Study 2:30p BM Music 6:30p Play Reh.	17 Newsletter items due 9:30a BM Music 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	18 8:45a BM Music
19 9a Worship 10a Ed/Fell 11a Worship 5p Play Reh. 7p SAA 7p Vent.Crew	20 <i>Presidents' Day</i> 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2p BM Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Play Reh. 6:30p Book Study 6:30p Women's Soul Group	21 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p BM Music 6:30p Play Reh. 6:30p Toastmasters	22 5p Methodicals 5:30p Wed. Supper 6p Play Reh. 6:15p Children/ Youth Prog. 6:45p Chancel Choir	23 9a Fun & Fit 9a Minnehaha Playdate 10a Book Study 2:30p BM Music 6p Play Reh. 6:30p Trustees & B+G	24 9a Newsletter Collation 9:30a BM Music 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA 7p Seussical	25 7a MinneHarvest 8:30a My Changing Self 8:45a BM Music 7p Seussical
26 9a Worship 10a Ed/Fell 11a Worship 2p Seussical 6p Youth & Conf. Classes 6:30p Togo Ch. 7p SAA	27 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2p BM Music 6:30p Cub & Boy Scouts	28 <i>Mardi Gras</i> 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p BM Music 6p Nokomis Prov. Group 7p SPR	Notes: The Fellowship Hall is reserved for Auction Setup beginning Feb. 26 after the musical.			

Worship in February

We continue our series on the New New Testament, hearing about 5 different books that were written around the same time as the other books of the New Testament, but aren't in the Bible. We end the month with a celebration of camping on February 26, and then Lent begins on March 1!

5th	"A New New Testament: The Gospel of Thomas"	Thomas 24, 25, 77
	<i>Communion</i>	
12th	"A New New Testament: The First Book of the Odes of Solomon"	Odes of Solomon 6
19th	"A New New Testament: The Acts of Paul & Thecla"	The Acts of Paul & Thecla 40 & 41
26th	Camping Sunday	

Future Events at Minnehaha UMC—

Save the Date (not including events that happen monthly):

- Mar. 1 – 6:30 Ash Wednesday (beginning of Lent)
Worship service
- Mar. 4 – 11:01 Auction
- Mar. 8 – Beginning of Lenten Study on prayer practices, 6:15-7
- Mar. 2 – Beginning of Adult Study on Night
- Mar. 12 – Daylight Savings begins (turn clocks ahead)
- Mar. 18 – Boy Scouts Pinewood Derby
- April 9 – Palm Sunday
- April 13 – Maundy Thursday (service at 7:00)
- April 14 – Good Friday themed Taizé service here at 7:00
- Good Friday service at Richfield UMC at 7:00
- April 16 – Easter! (services at 7, 9, 11)
- May 7 – Bibles for 2nd graders at both worship services
- May 21 – One worship service at 10:00 – Children's Musical
- May 22 – 2:00 Trip to see SweetLand at the History Theatre



A look forward into Youth Ministries at Minnehaha..

Feb. 5 *Super Bowl "Subs for Scholarships" Sunday: Youth will be meeting in the church kitchen at 8:30am to prepare sub sandwiches that will be for sale after both services. Proceeds will go to help youth camps and scholarships, so please stop by the Narthex after worship and pick up the family some sub sandwiches for lunch!

***No evening Confirmation classes – Enjoy the Game!**

Feb. 12 * Youth will be Giving out Hugs after both services in honor of upcoming Valentines day

***Youth night: Packing sandwiches for homeless –** Youth grades 6th-12th will be getting together from 6:00-7:30pm to put together and pack as many sandwiches they can, and then will be donating them to the 363 Food distribution program that will hand them out to the homeless. We are asking each youth to bring a 5-10 dollar donation to help pay for the food if they can.

Feb. 19 *President's Day weekend – No Confirmation classes

Feb. 22 *Sunrise Service Rehearsal - Youth grades 6th-12th will be getting together from 6:30-8:00pm to start planning and preparing for this years Easter Sunrise Service.

Feb. 26 *Camp Sunday: Youth are having a Bake sale to raise money for our camps! All Youth will be encouraged to make treats together at home to bring in and sell after both services. There will also be tables up with info about all of MUMC's summer camps, so please come find us in the Narthex and pick up registration forms while you find a delicious treat to buy.

***Confirmation class lesson: Jesus' Teachings -** Classes start at 6:00pm and go until 7:30pm

Feb. 28 *Youth celebrating Fat Tuesday - Youth grades 6th-12th will be getting together from 6:30-8:00pm to learn all about Fat Tuesday, Ash Wednesday, and Lent. We will be meeting in the kitchen to have a pancake feast during our class and youth are encouraged to bring their favorite pancake toppings to share!

Future Important Dates:

Mar. 1 Ash Wednesday dinner and service

Mar. 4 Church Auction: Youth will be serving food from 9am-1pm

Mar. 5 Confirmation: Jesus' Parables

Mar. 12 Youth night: Skyzone Trampoline Park

Mar. 18 Pinewood Derby: Youth serve meal & Race

July 16-18 Minnehaha Youth

Camp: 6th-7th Grade

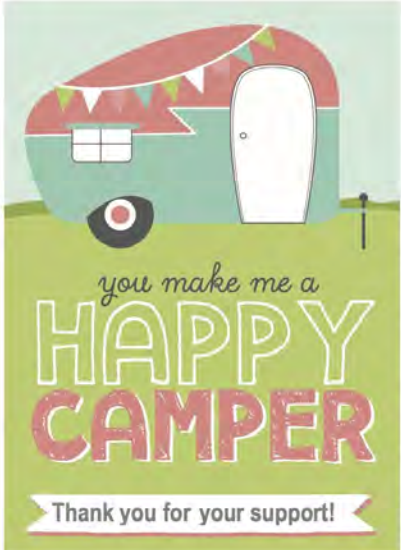
July 23-28 Youth Confirmation

Camp: 8th-12th Grade

For more info about any dates or events please contact:

Leilani Thompson,
Director of Youth Ministries

leilanithompson@msn.com



CAMPING SUNDAY
26th February 2017

Pull out your hiking boots, your flannel shirts, and mosquito repellent. Find your headlamp and canoe paddles. It's camping time, and we hope you'll join us!

Throughout the morning – in worship and beyond – we'll celebrate our camping experiences, and reflect on how they help us grow as individuals, grow our relationships, and grow our faith.

Information about summer programs and camping opportunities will be available; and there will be opportunities to contribute to our scholarship fund.

Thank you for your support!

Children's Ministries

As we move firmly into 2017, we change gears a bit with Children's Programming. Wednesday Nights start up, we begin preparing for Children's Sunday, and summer plans come into focus.

Our goals this winter are to continue to grow intergenerational opportunities, to create new educational programs for families around inner faith dialogue and community, and to find new ways to support parents of young children. In the course of the next few months, Children's Council will be sending out a survey to find out what people are most interested in and have the energy to commit to. In the meanwhile, we encourage you to take advantage of the programs we have, and consider what we can do as a community to take care of our children, one another, and the world.

Looking ahead to this month of February, we've got:

Regular **Sunday** morning worship (9 & 11am) & Sunday School (10:15am)

Wednesday Night Dinners (5:30-6:30pm) followed by programming for children from 6:15-7pm

Thursday Mornings - Minnehaha Playgroup from 9-11am

Friday, 24th, Saturday, 25th at 7pm and Sunday 26th at 2pm: Come see the all-church musical: *Seussical the Musical*, Jr.

Saturday, 25th is My Changing Self - a day long workshop for 3rd-8th graders exploring issues around identity, sexuality, and spirituality. This year, our afternoon speakers include people from the Reconciling Network and the Jacob Wetterling Foundation - and we'll look at bullying, media safety, and more. Registration is open, the link is on the church website

Sunday, 26th is Camping Sunday! The children will sing in worship, and we'll be fully embracing the camping theme (where flannel and hiking boots, etc.) while we share information about this summer's programs and raise money for camping scholarships.

If you're ready to look ahead to March, you can mark your calendars with this information: Lent will begin on Wednesday, March 1st with Ash Wednesday, the church auction & a childcare night are on Saturday, March 4th.

As always, please contact me should you have any questions or concerns about Children's Ministries, or if you have some ideas about what you'd like to see us doing!

Thanks for all that you do, and for sharing your children with us!

Jenia Strom
Director of Children & Family Ministries



Minnehaha Playgroup

For Children 5 and Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9-11am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

hosted by

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

When weather permits, we gather at local parks for playgroup. Otherwise, we meet at Minnehaha UMC, in the Childcare Room. If you'd like to join us on any given week, and want to know where to find us: join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" Facebook Page for weekly updates.



Highlights from the January 10, 2017 Church Council Meeting

“TWO THUMBS UP” IN 2016: Minnehaha UMC had a “two thumbs up” year in 2016, according to our Pastor, Treasurer and Finance Chair:

We added 22 new members

Average weekly worship attendance was up by 5 people

We finished the year with a surplus of \$6,337 (thanks to lower than average natural gas prices, a near doubling of our income from fundraising and two generous bequests to the church)

The mortgage for our 2010 building project is down to \$388,000

STEWARDSHIP PLEDGES ARE UP IN 2017: The “Imagine...” stewardship campaign for 2017 was a success, with about half of our givers increasing their pledges over the previous year. Thank you! This puts us in a strong position to do more in 2017. Note: If you haven’t yet made a pledge, get a form from the office and drop it in the offering plate or mail it to the church. (Sue Claude, Finance Chair)

2017 BUDGET ENDORSED BY CHURCH COUNCIL: The Finance Committee presented its 2017 budget to the Council. It includes a projected increase in contributions, as well continued rental income from Mandala Montessori and Brighter Minds Music. In terms of expenses, more funds are allocated to expand our children’s programming and for organ and sidewalk repairs. In order to balance the budget, it includes a special spring appeal to raise \$10,000 to cover the added expenses. The 2017 church budget will be presented to the congregation for approval at the Annual Meeting and Church Conference on Sunday, January 22 at 1:00 PM. (Sue Claude, Finance Chair)

EVENT CLEAN-UP PROPOSAL APPROVED: Going forward, groups hosting major events like the Auction, Harvest Dinner, Annual Bazaar, Halloween Carnival and Christmas Pageant will pay a non-refundable set-up/clean-up fee to help cover the extra time required of our custodian. The groups are also responsible for cleaning up any areas used, using a Clean-up Checklist as their guide. The proposal also asks for a direct point of contact for each group, and includes instructions on dishwasher operation and the location of key cleaning tools and supplies. An abridged clean-up checklist will also be circulated to regular groups/committees who meet in the church so they “leave no trace” once they’re done meeting. (Dean Ammerman, Council Chair)

YOUTH MAKING MADE-TO-ORDER SUB SANDWICHES: As a fundraiser for mission trips, Minnehaha UMC’s youth will sell submarine sandwiches for Super Bowl Sunday on February 5. You’ll fill out an advance order form listing the ingredients you want, and the youth will make them and hand them out on the 5th. (Jason Emrick, Coordinator of Youth Ministries)

“SEUSSICAL JR” MUSICAL FEB. 24-26: The UMW-sponsored all-church play this year is the fantastical musical extravaganza “Seussical JR.” The musical includes several of your favorite Dr. Seuss characters, including Horton the Elephant and the Cat in the Hat. Performances will be February 24 and 25 (7:00 PM) and 26 (2:00 PM). We hope you can make it! (Maureen Trepp, Chair, United Methodist Women)

FOOD SHELF FUNDRAISER SUCCESSES: The Riverview Theater Christmas movie food shelf fundraiser in December and the Pasta Dinner fundraiser on January 11 were big successes. The movie fundraiser brought in 2,200 lbs. of food and \$2,762. The Pasta Dinner fundraiser—featuring an accordion band and food donated by Fat Lorenzo’s—brought more than 330 people into the church, and raised nearly \$5,000. This is clear evidence of the neighborhood’s support of the Food Shelf, which is an ecumenical mission of St. James Episcopal, Lake Nokomis Lutheran and Minnehaha United Methodist Churches. (Judy Durfey, Food Shelf Chair)

MY CHANGING SELF WORKSHOP FEB. 25: MY CHANGING SELF: A class for 3rd - 8th graders on “Exploring Sexuality, Spirituality and Identity” at Lake Harriet United Methodist Church on Feb. 25 from 8:30 a.m. to 3:30 p.m. (Parent workshop from 8:30 to 10:30 a.m.) Child care provided. (Jenia Strom, Coordinator of Children’s Ministries)

Continued from pg. 6

NEXT MEETING MARCH 14 AT 6:30 PM: The next Church Council meeting is scheduled for March 14 at 6:30 p.m. (The Council decided to observe Valentine's Day rather than meet in February, believe it or not.) Everyone in the church is invited to attend. Complete minutes of the meeting are available on request.

—submitted by Dean Ammerman, Church Council Chair

Healing Hearts Minnehaha

As followers of Christ, we are called to be healers, spread love, and carry God's light through the world. One way that we can do this is through art.

Join us on Saturday, February 11 from 4:30-7:30 for creating "healing hearts" art pieces. We'll have a chili supper (with a vegetarian option) and work together on heart-themed art pieces, which will then be prayerfully gifted to those who need to feel love and care.

This is an inter-generational event, and all are welcome. We will be using a variety of media to express ourselves. This is for all, regardless of perceived artistic talent!

An RSVP is not necessary, but would be helpful for planning purposes. Chili and fixin's provided, please bring an accompaniment or dessert to share. Call Sue Johnson at 612-462-3539 with questions or to RSVP.

Books That Didn't Make the Bible

Scholars and archeologists have found a long list of book and letters that were considered for inclusion in the Bible but didn't make the cut, for some reason or another. Some we have just fragments of, and some we have in almost their entirety. In conjunction with the sermon series that began January 22, we are studying five of those books over five weeks. Ones like the Gospel of Thomas and the Gospel of Mary you probably have heard of, but others, like Thunder: Perfect Mind and Odes of Solomon might be new to you. Whether you've read all of them or none of them, come to the study. You will want to read them in advance of each class (the books are fairly short, just a couple pages) along with an introduction from author and professor Hal Toussig, so either pick up a hard copy from Becky some Sunday, or email her and she will send out a scanned copy to you electronically. The same class will be offered each week on Monday evenings (6:30-7:30) and Thursday mornings (10:00-11:00).

- Mon., Jan. 30 & Thurs. Feb. 2 – The Gospel of Mary
- Mon. Feb. 6 & Thurs. Feb. 9 – The Gospel of Thomas
- Mon. Feb. 13 & Thurs. Feb. 16 – The First Book of the Odes of Solomon
- Mon. Feb. 20 & Thurs. Feb. 23 – The Acts of Paul & Thecla

What Next? Advocating for Our Neighbors After the March

On January 20th, members of Minnehaha UMC attended the Women's March in St. Paul and in Washington D.C. Come together to hear about those experiences, to talk about what your own areas of concern, interest, passion, and skills are; and, to make action plans as a community.

WHO: ALL ARE INVITED

WHEN: Sunday, 12th February, following second service (about noon)

WHERE: Minnehaha UMC Fellowship Hall

A SOUP & BREAD lunch will be provided

CHILDCARE is available

QUESTIONS?

Contact Gail Minehart or Jenia Strom

Mission Statement of the Women's March:

We stand together in solidarity with our partners and children for the protection of our rights, our safety, our health, and our families - recognizing that our vibrant and diverse communities are the strength of our country.

If you have photos from either march you'd like to share with others, please get a digital copy of them to Jenia Strom and she'll include them in the slideshow.

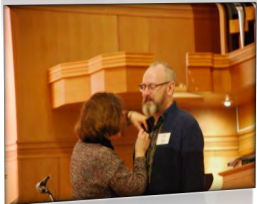
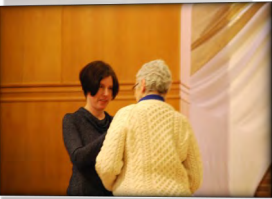
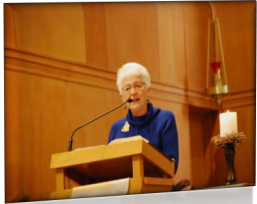


United Methodist Women

Our Circles continue to meet often and we have had one funeral at which the Wenonah Circle helped serve. The all Church musical, "Seussical Jr." (which is funded with UMW money) is in rehearsal and will be performed on Feb. 24, 25 and 26th. Please come. We will be serving at Simpson Shelter on March 21st, if you are interested in helping, please add that date to your calendar.

Toy Drive

A very special thank you to the generous and thoughtful members for their contributions to the Christmas charity toy giveaway. There were many smiles as well as tears of gratitude expressed by parents. You helped to make it another success as over 200 children received a toy, a stocking stuffer, a hat and gloves.



the Minnehaha Players proudly present

Seussical Jr.

Meet all your favorite characters as
they rhyme their way through Dr. Seuss stories!

**When: Friday, Feb. 24 &
Saturday, Feb. 25 at 7:00pm
& Sunday Feb. 26 at 2:00pm**

**Where: Minnehaha United
Methodist Church; 3701 E.
50th Street, Minneapolis**

**There will be a freewill donation
taken for the missions sponsored
by Minnehaha UMW**



IAM®20 Meditation Class:

Learn an effective 20 minute meditation technique for busy people

IAM®20 –Integrated Amrita Meditation®—is a meditation technique created by Mata Amritanandamayi, a world famous saint from India (www.amma.org for more info on her). In 20 minutes per day, IAM®20 promotes integration of body, mind, and spirit. Practitioners report feeling more relaxed and centered. Regular practice of IAM® lowers stress hormone (adrenaline and cortisol) levels, according to an 8 month follow up study. IAM®20 is a secular meditation which integrates easily into any spiritual or health support practice regimen. For more info about IAM®, go to www.integratedmeditation.org.

When: Saturday, Feb 4, 2017, from 1-4 pm

Where: Minnehaha United Methodist Church, 3701 E 50th Street, MPLS 55417

REGISTER EARLY, BRING A FRIEND: Please send name, phone number and email address to meditationiam@gmail.com or call Arun Hejmadi 719-963-5244.

Monthly Communion at Nokomis Square

On the second Thursday of the month at 1:00 p.m., Becky offers a brief communion service at Nokomis Square preceded by a discussion of the chapter we are reading for the week in *We Make The Road By Walking*. Anyone is welcome to come. This month we will be gathering on February 9.

Prayer in Lent

This year during Lent (the 6-week period of preparation before Easter), we'll be focusing on prayer. In addition to that being the sermon focus each week, we'll be exploring different prayer practices on Wednesday evenings from 6:15-7:00 p.m. Join us as we practice praying in color, through the labyrinth, with the daily news, with our bodies, and concluding with a prayer walk through the neighborhood on April 5.

AUCTION

Saturday, March 4



Coffee & Doughnuts:

10 AM – 12 Noon

Auction Preview:

10 AM

AUCTION STARTS:

11:01 AM

Lunch Served:

12 Noon – 1:30 PM

Note: All items must be removed from the church property by 5 PM on March 4. **Saturday, 3/4 only:** \$25 delivery fee for purchased items within a 10 mile radius of Minnehaha United Methodist Church.

**Cabinets, desks, collectibles, housewares,
furniture, antiques, gift certificates, food, crafts,
electronics, kid stuff: toys, books, more!**

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

3701 East 50th Street | Minneapolis, MN | 612-721-6231 | www.minnehaha.org

What Would Jesus Do?

Elie Wiesel wrote a memoir in 1958 in Yiddish. It was translated into French and English, and most recently revised and translated by his wife in 2006. It details in graphic detail the horrific events of a Jewish youth in a concentration camp. The book is short; the account, a lesson of something that should never happen ever again. For this writing and others, Wiesel received the Nobel Peace Prize in 1986.

This book, focused on the efforts of the Nazis to destroy the Jewish population seems an unlikely book for discussion in Lent, but in Lent, Christians face a darkness, so perhaps this writing is pertinent for the season. In addition, human rights are threatened and people killed in spite of the lessons of history.

For those of you who would want to discuss Wiesel's book in connection with our own faith, I invite you to join this 4-week session 10:00 am on Thursdays in Lent starting March 2. You can find the book at local libraries, your own bookshelves, or on the internet. Please let me know.

Judy Durfey (651-590-0568)

Taizé

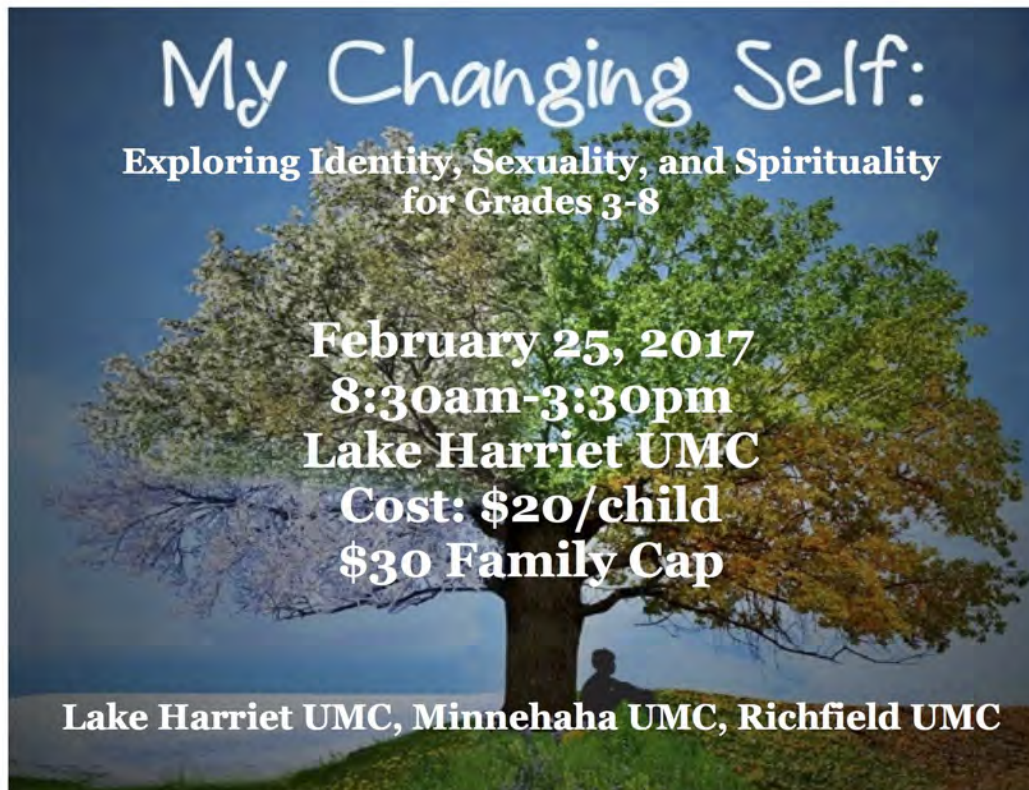
For some of you, the Sunday morning worship does not provide enough time for quiet, reflection, prayer and silence. We invite you to feed your soul with our monthly Taizé Service. The service is modeled after the worship services at the ecumenical community of Taizé, located in eastern France. The service has prayer, scripture, and music. The songs have few words, sung repetitively, in order to allow for deep contemplation and prayer.

Ash Wednesday

Lent begins on Wednesday, March 1 this year, and we will be starting our Lenten observance with an Ash Wednesday service at 6:30 p.m. If you've never been to an Ash Wednesday service before, this is a more solemn service that includes ashes made from the burning of palms from last year's Palm Sunday. We "impose" the ashes as a reminder of how sometimes even our best intentions can go awry, and as a reminder of our own mortality. All ages are invited to participate in the service. There will be a dinner from 5:30-6:15 that same evening, and the rest of our Lenten programming will begin the following Wednesday (March 8).

MUMC at the Movies

We'd like to start a new adult event – a monthly opportunity to watch a movie and discuss it with others. To celebrate (or grieve) the end of football season, we'll have our first movie-watching opportunity on Sunday, February 12 at 2:00. The day and time will probably get tweaked in the future, but let's start with watching *Lars and the Real Girl* which is about a community's response to one of their members falling in love with an inflatable doll. Becky is willing to kick off this first event, but if someone else would be willing to coordinate, please talk to Becky. Popcorn will be provided, but please bring your own beverage, and also a list of movies you think would make for good watching and discussion afterwards.





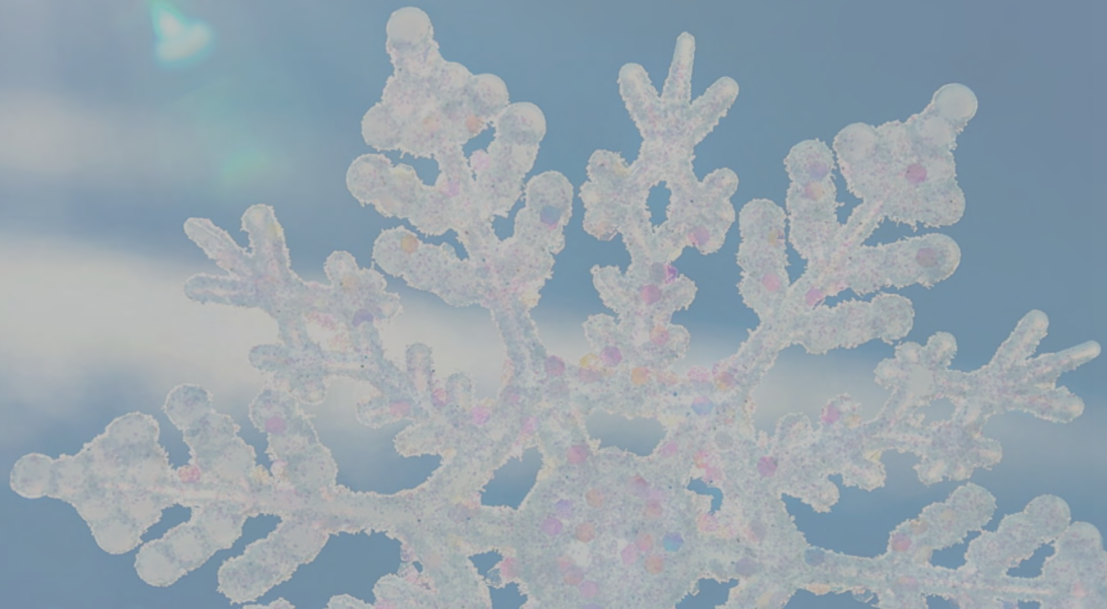
Epiphany

It's not very often that we get to enjoy a long season of Epiphany. Epiphany is one of those seasons in the Christian year that flexes. It starts after January 6 (which is The Epiphany) and lasts until Lent begins. Since the beginning of Lent depends on when Easter falls, the season of Epiphany can be very short or quite long. With Easter on April 16 this year, Lent doesn't start until March 1, which give us most of the month of January and the entire month of February for Epiphany.

I don't know about you, but I don't often find the month of February to be favorable for epiphanies. I often find myself tired winter and wishing we were moving closer to spring. The increase in light is nice, but not nearly fast enough. It's a good thing it's a short month, because I find myself tiring of it halfway through.

This year, though, I'm going to try a new spiritual practice. I'm going to practice paying attention to epiphanies during the season of epiphany. There is a great nighttime practice that has been adapted by many groups and used in a variety of ways by many ages that is pretty simple. As you are preparing to go to sleep, make a brief list of the things that didn't go well and offer them to God in prayer, letting go of them in the process. Then make a brief list of what did go well, and offer thanks to God for those things. Then, if there is anything that is weighing on you for the next day, offer that to God in prayer as well, trusting that God will care for that and asking for wisdom in dealing with it in a new day. It's a simple practice, and I've found that whether I'm sharing it as "highs and lows" with a Boundary Waters camp or just journaling by myself, there are epiphanies in each day. The letting go of disappointment can be powerful, and remembering the good things often has a nugget of epiphany in it. Trusting that God will worry for me in a new day can be refreshing and freeing. So, that will be my "Epiphany" practice this month. I invite you to try it with me, or find your own spiritual practice that will allow you to experience epiphanies during the season of Epiphany.

In joy,
Becky





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2/17





**Join us at Minnehaha for
Wednesday Night Suppers!**

Throughout the winter and spring, join us for
supper from 5:30-6:30 in the Fellowship Hall.

Cost for Dinner:
\$5 for those 4 years and older
Free for children under 4
Family Cap: \$20
**PURCHASE A PUNCH CARD &
RECEIVE FOUR MEALS FREE!**

Following dinner, there is
programming for children from 6:15 to
7pm.